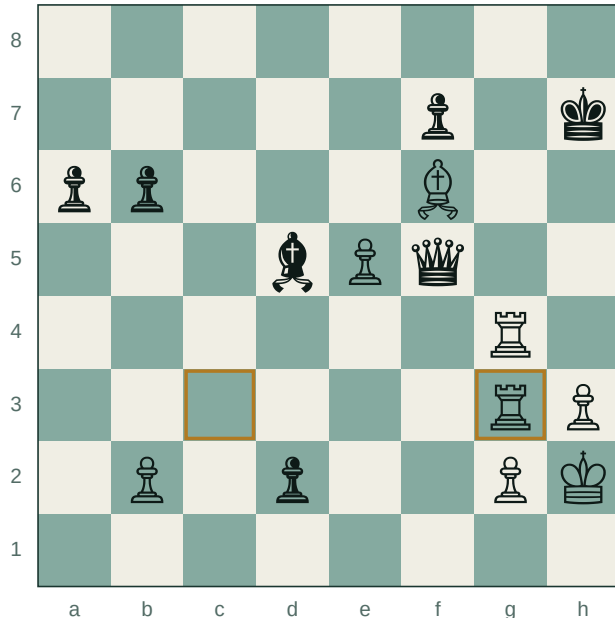


Promotion combinations: Black, move 47

Promotion combinations

Black to move



Previous move: 47.Rcg3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

47...Qxg4 48. Rxxg4 d1=Q 49. Rg7+ Kh6

47...Qxg4 The queen captures the rook on g4. Recorded reply: **48.Rxxg4**.

48...d1=Q The pawn moves from d2 to d1. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **49.Rg7+**.

49...Kh6 The king moves from h7 to h6.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on h2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.